

ÁLVARO PEÑUELAS SÁNCHEZ

Marine & Lacustrine Ecologist · Environmental Data Analyst · EIA

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PROFILE

Marine and lacustrine ecologist with a Cum Laude MSc and an academic mention in Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA). Strong quantitative background: Python and R for ecological data analysis, species distribution modelling, statistical trend analysis, and reproducible reporting pipelines. Multi-ecosystem field experience across NE Atlantic, tropical coastal and SE Asian systems. EU citizen, available immediately, open to relocation.

EDUCATION

MSc Marine and Lacustrine Science and Management

2023–2025

VUB / UGhent / University of Antwerp — Inter-university programme · Cum Laude

- Thesis: Mitochondrial phylogeography of *Cypridopsis vidua* — 170 COI sequences, ML/Bayesian inference, four species-delimitation methods (ABGD, ASAP, bPTP, KoT). Manuscript in prep for *Hydrobiologia*.
- Coursework: Ecological Modelling; GIS and Spatial Analysis; Marine Biogeochemistry; Ocean Remote Sensing; Marine Policy and Management

BSc Biology · Mention in Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)

2020–2023

Universidad de Navarra · Exchange year: Nottingham Trent University, UK (2022–2023)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Environmental Assessment: EIA framework and methodology (academic mention); biodiversity baselines; impact prediction and significance evaluation; EU directives (WFD, MSFD)

Programming & Data Analysis: Python (pandas, matplotlib, seaborn, folium, scikit-learn); R (ggplot2, vegan, Mann-Kendall trend analysis); reproducible pipelines

Modelling & GIS: Species distribution modelling (Random Forest, Bio-ORACLE v3.0); QGIS spatial analysis; satellite imagery (Sentinel-2, Landsat, MODIS); GBIF, OBIS, FAO FishStat

Molecular & Lab: COI barcoding; DNA extraction and sequencing; phylogenetic inference (ML, Bayesian); species delimitation methods

Field: Marine transect surveys; benthic photo-quadrat analysis; aquaculture assessment; conservation monitoring; PADI Open Water Diver

RESEARCH & FIELD EXPERIENCE

Aquaculture & Sustainability Assessment — Cat Ba, Vietnam

2024

Field interviews and observational research on small-scale aquaculture systems; practical tools for sustainable practice adoption with local practitioners.

Coastal Ecosystem Monitoring — Marine Reserve of Abades, Tenerife

2024

Seagrass transect surveys; benthic photographic analysis; biodiversity and ecosystem dynamics assessment in nearshore systems.

Marine Turtle Conservation & Monitoring — Boa Vista, Cabo Verde (BIOS)

2022–2023

Nesting site monitoring; hatchery management protocols; volunteer training and data collection templates.

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Peñuelas Sánchez, A. et al. *Cypridopsis vidua* reproductive modes and cryptic diversification: a molecular and morphological approach. Manuscript in preparation. Target journal: *Hydrobiologia* (Special Issue). Role: lead researcher.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (advanced) · French (intermediate) · German (intermediate)